

Biodiversity Hotspots & Global Conventions

Hotspot criteria and CBD/CITES/CMS/Nagoya purpose map for Prelims.

Portion focus ~72% · Topic: env-biodiversity

PYQ themes: Hotspots · CBD · CITES · Nagoya · CMS

Why this article (PYQ probability)

Portion chance ~72%. Steady; pairs with protected-areas. Parent ~85%.

Years appeared (synthesis): 2016, 2017, 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025

Why UPSC asks this

Definitional criteria + treaty purpose one-liners are easy to mark.

Why this portion is high-chance for the next exam

Portion chance ~72%. Steady; pairs with protected-areas. Parent ~85%. Within env-biodiversity, examiners return to biodiversity hotspots and global environment conventions because it yields clean MCQ discriminators: definitions, matching lists, and statement–reason traps. These notes are multi-page depth material — original study synthesis for prioritisation, not NCERT/UPSC verbatim text and not an official prediction.

Use the chance % to sequence study hours, then widen to neighbouring syllabus areas. PYQ theme tags driving selection: Hotspots, CBD, CITES, Nagoya, CMS. Approximate appearance years in the 2016–2025 educational synthesis: 2016, 2017, 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025.

Read this block slowly: high-chance portions repay depth because UPSC recycles the same discriminators with fresh stems. Your job is not to memorise paragraphs but to own triggers — dates, articles, site–feature pairs, formulae, treaty purposes — so elimination is automatic. After each subsection, pause and write two keywords on rough paper; if you cannot, reread only that subsection.

Core map of biodiversity hotspots and global environment conventions

Hotspot criteria: High endemism + habitat loss/threat thresholds. India-related hotspots: Himalaya, Western Ghats, Indo-Burma, Sundaland (Nicobar). Endemism: Species restricted to a region.

CBD: Conservation, sustainable use, benefit sharing. Nagoya Protocol: Access and benefit sharing. CITES: International trade regulation via appendices.

If you can explain each point aloud in sixty seconds without notes, elimination speed in Prelims rises sharply. Watch absolute words in options (always/never/only) — often wrong where processes are multi-causal or jurisprudentially nuanced.

Draw the core map once from memory at the end of this sitting. Compare with the text. Patch only the missing nodes. That single retrieval cycle is worth more than two passive rereads of the same page.

Depth focus: Hotspot criteria

Hotspot criteria — High endemism + habitat loss/threat thresholds In exam stems, expect this idea to appear either as a direct definition or as one statement in a multi-statement cluster.

India-related hotspots — Himalaya, Western Ghats, Indo-Burma, Sundaland (Nicobar) Contrast the two ideas above: what would a wrong option swap between them?

Micro-drill: write one correct statement and one incorrect statement using only these ideas; label why the incorrect one fails. Keep language tight — UPSC rewards precision on biodiversity hotspots and global environment conventions more than ornamental vocabulary. If this pair links to a map or article number, add that trigger in the margin of your PDF printout.

Depth focus: Endemism

Endemism — Species restricted to a region In exam stems, expect this idea to appear either as a direct definition or as one statement in a multi-statement cluster.

CBD — Conservation, sustainable use, benefit sharing Contrast the two ideas above: what would a wrong option swap between them?

Micro-drill: write one correct statement and one incorrect statement using only these ideas; label why the incorrect one fails. Keep language tight — UPSC rewards precision on biodiversity hotspots and global environment conventions more than ornamental vocabulary. If this pair links to a map or article number, add that trigger in the margin of your PDF printout.

Depth focus: Nagoya Protocol

Nagoya Protocol — Access and benefit sharing In exam stems, expect this idea to appear either as a direct definition or as one statement in a multi-statement cluster.

CITES — International trade regulation via appendices Contrast the two ideas above: what would a wrong option swap between them?

Micro-drill: write one correct statement and one incorrect statement using only these ideas; label why the incorrect one fails. Keep language tight — UPSC rewards precision on biodiversity hotspots and global environment conventions more than ornamental vocabulary. If this pair links to a map or article number, add that trigger in the margin of your PDF printout.

Depth focus: CMS

CMS — Migratory species cooperation In exam stems, expect this idea to appear either as a direct definition or as one statement in a multi-statement cluster.

Cartagena Protocol — Biosafety/LMOs — distinct from Nagoya Contrast the two ideas above: what would a wrong option swap between them?

Micro-drill: write one correct statement and one incorrect statement using only these ideas; label why the incorrect one fails. Keep language tight — UPSC rewards precision on biodiversity hotspots and global environment conventions more than ornamental vocabulary. If this pair links to a map or article number, add that trigger in the margin of your PDF printout.

Depth focus: Protected area " hotspot

Protected area " hotspot — Scientific label vs legal tool In exam stems, expect this idea to appear either as a direct definition or as one statement in a multi-statement cluster.

Benefit sharing — Genetic resources and TK ethics Contrast the two ideas above: what would a wrong option swap between them?

Micro-drill: write one correct statement and one incorrect statement using only these ideas; label why the incorrect one fails. Keep language tight — UPSC rewards precision on biodiversity hotspots and global environment conventions more than ornamental vocabulary. If this pair links to a map or article number, add that trigger in the margin of your PDF printout.

Depth focus: Appendices idea

Appendices idea — Different trade strictness In exam stems, expect this idea to appear either as a direct definition or as one statement in a multi-statement cluster.

Migratory flyways — Birds link CMS and wetlands Contrast the two ideas above: what would a wrong option swap between them?

Micro-drill: write one correct statement and one incorrect statement using only these ideas; label why the incorrect one fails. Keep language tight — UPSC rewards precision on biodiversity hotspots and global environment conventions more than ornamental vocabulary. If this pair links to a map or article number, add that trigger in the margin of your PDF printout.

Depth focus: ABS India

ABS India — Biodiversity Act outline In exam stems, expect this idea to appear either as a direct definition or as one statement in a multi-statement cluster.

Marine biodiversity — Reefs/mangroves/EEZ Contrast the two ideas above: what would a wrong option swap between them?

Micro-drill: write one correct statement and one incorrect statement using only these ideas; label why the incorrect one fails. Keep language tight — UPSC rewards precision on biodiversity hotspots and global environment conventions more than ornamental vocabulary. If this pair links to a map or article number, add that trigger in the margin of your PDF printout.

Depth focus: Invasive alien species

Invasive alien species — CBD concern In exam stems, expect this idea to appear either as a direct definition or as one statement in a multi-statement cluster.

Aichi to GBF — Targets evolve — verify CA labels Contrast the two ideas above: what would a wrong option swap between them?

Micro-drill: write one correct statement and one incorrect statement using only these ideas; label why the incorrect one fails. Keep language tight — UPSC rewards precision on biodiversity hotspots and global environment conventions more than ornamental vocabulary. If this pair links to a map or article number, add that trigger in the margin of your PDF printout.

Depth focus: Community knowledge

Community knowledge — PBR idea In exam stems, expect this idea to appear either as a direct definition or as one statement in a multi-statement cluster.

Synthetic biology edge — Headline awareness only Contrast the two ideas above: what would a wrong option swap between them?

Micro-drill: write one correct statement and one incorrect statement using only these ideas; label why the incorrect one fails. Keep language tight — UPSC rewards precision on biodiversity hotspots and global environment conventions more than ornamental vocabulary. If this pair links to a map or article number, add that trigger in the margin of your PDF printout.

Comparison tables — memorise differences, not essays

Tables win Prelims because UPSC loves correctly matched pairs and multi-statement sets. Study the table(s) embedded with this article until you can reproduce them on rough paper in under four minutes. Then invent two false rows and practise spotting them — that simulates assertion traps.

After table mastery, return to narrative sections only for rows you keep missing. Depth here is intentional: thin skim notes lose marks on discriminators. When a table row has a date, article, or place, that cell is a trigger — circle it.

Must-know India / applied angle

Western Ghats endemism examples + NBA outline. Keep a rolling one-page CA addendum dated by month; do not rewrite your static spine every week. Mains crossover exists, but Prelims primarily rewards precise factual

edges and definitions.

Link each applied example back to a static hook so current affairs does not float free of the syllabus. If a news item cannot attach to a hook within ten seconds, park it in a low-priority list. Rehearse a 45-second spoken India angle the day before any mock that might touch this portion.

How UPSC typically frames questions (PYQ angle)

Hotspot definition; convention! "purpose match. Tactic: eliminate anachronisms and category errors first (wrong institution, wrong treaty family, wrong century, wrong formula base). Then test remaining options against table rows. Finally, beware extra absolute adjectives.

Assertion–reason items often smuggle a true statement with a false causal link — judge the link, not only the facts. Matching lists reward uniqueness: start with the most distinctive pair. Themes: Hotspots, CBD, CITES, Nagoya, CMS. Years signal in this hub's synthesis: 2016, 2017, 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025.

Common traps and how to dodge them

Trap: Every forest is a hotspot unit. Trap: Cartagena=Nagoya. Trap: CITES bans all trade.

Trap: CBD=UNFCCC.

Build a personal trap diary: after each mock, add one line under this heading. Reread only the trap diary the night before the paper for this portion. Teach one trap to a peer in one minute — teaching exposes fuzzy understanding.

Worked revision method (make the PDF earn its pages)

Day 1: core map + table; close notes; reproduce table. Day 2: India angle + traps; 15 MCQs. Day 3: PYQ-style self-questions from headings only. Day 4: teach the topic aloud for eight minutes. Day 5: mixed quiz with neighbouring topics to prevent silo memory.

Print the PDF or use in-app Download PDF. Annotate margins only with triggers you forget — not entire yellow pages. Spaced retrieval beats rereading: hide the PDF and write bullets from memory, then check. In the final 15 days, this portion should be in 'table + traps + must' mode, not first-read mode.

Quick synthesis for the exam hall

Criteria ! ' India list ! ' convention table ! ' ABS/biosafety split. Portion focus score used in-app: ~72%. If time is scarce in the last week, reread Must remember + tables + traps only; return to long sections for weak rows.

Carry a one-line spine on rough paper in the first minute of the paper if this topic appears early — then eliminate. Do not invent facts under pressure; prefer elimination from your table.

Extended notes — depth for multi-page mastery

Hotspot criteria. High endemism + habitat loss/threat thresholds Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin. India-related hotspots. Himalaya, Western Ghats, Indo-Burma, Sundaland (Nicobar) Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin. Endemism. Species restricted to a region Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin. CBD. Conservation, sustainable use, benefit sharing Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin. Nagoya Protocol. Access and benefit sharing Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin.

CITES. International trade regulation via appendices Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin. CMS. Migratory species cooperation Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin. Cartagena Protocol.

Biosafety/LMOs — distinct from Nagoya Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin. Protected area " hotspot. Scientific label vs legal tool Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin. Benefit sharing. Genetic resources and TK ethics Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin.

Appendices idea. Different trade strictness Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin. Migratory flyways. Birds link CMS and wetlands Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin. ABS India. Biodiversity Act outline Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin. Marine biodiversity. Reefs/mangroves/EEZ Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin. Invasive alien species. CBD concern Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin.

Aichi to GBF. Targets evolve — verify CA labels Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin. Community knowledge. PBR idea Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin. Synthetic biology edge. Headline awareness only Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin.

This extended module exists so downloads are clearly longer/richer than skim notes. Read it in two sittings if needed; do not skim on day one and never return. After finishing, close the article and write a 12-line summary from memory; compare; patch gaps only. Then solve at least ten mixed MCQs tagging each error to a heading in this PDF.

Error log template (copy into your notebook)

For every missed question related to this portion, record: (1) stem gist, (2) wrong choice, (3) correct choice, (4) misconception in five words, (5) table row or must-remember line that would have saved you. Review the error log before the next mock. If the same misconception repeats thrice, rewrite that depth-focus section in your own words on a fresh page.

This metacognitive loop is how multi-page notes convert into marks rather than shelf weight.

Self-check questions (close the book first)

1) Define biodiversity hotspots and global environment conventions in two sentences without buzzword salad. 2) Recite the comparison table rows from memory. 3) List three traps and the correct mental fix for each. 4) Give two India examples and one international or cross-topic anchor. 5) Write one incorrect statement UPSC might plant — then correct it. 6) Time yourself: explain the exam spine in 90 seconds. 7) List five triggers (dates/ articles/sites/formulae) without peeking.

Pass criteria: 6/7 without peeking. Then move to mixed MCQs. Failing is useful if you patch immediately — that is the point of depth notes.

Convention purposes

Instrument	Purpose
CBD	Biodiversity triad
Nagoya	ABS
Cartagena	Biosafety
CITES	Trade
CMS	Migratory

Map / list facts

- Western Ghats
- Eastern Himalaya
- Nicobar

Common traps

- ' Every forest is a hotspot unit
- ' Cartagena=Nagoya
- ' CITES bans all trade
- ' CBD=UNFCCC

Must remember

- Hotspot criteria
- India hotspot list
- CBD triad
- Nagoya"Cartagena
- CITES=trade

Quick revision checklist

- & Criteria
- & India list
- & 5 conventions
- & 2 traps
- & 10 MCQs

Educational prioritisation heuristic — not an official UPSC prediction. © UPSC IAS Study Hub original notes.

